U.S. mainland and declared the Gulf of Mexico belonged to America.

The Carter administration, during the period when it was trying to bring home the U.S. hostages in Teheran, had canceled the Sixth Fleet's maneuvers in the Gulf of Sidra the previous year. Secretary of Defense Cap Weinberger urged me to resume the annual exercises, because he said if we continued accepting Qaddafi's claim that the gulf was a Libyan lake, we would be accepting a precedent that any nation could claim any patch of water outside the conventional twelve-mile limit and interfere with lawful shipping. I agreed with Cap and gave an order for the maneuvers to proceed in August. Then we'd see how Qaddafi responded to our decision.

On the same Sunday that I decided to appoint Sandra Day O'Connor to the Supreme Court, I had made another decision: Transportation Secretary Drew Lewis came to Camp David that day and told me that the Professional Air Traffic Controllers Organization, whose members manned Federal Aviation Administration airport control towers and radar centers around the country, was threatening to strike the following day because of our refusal to meet its demand for a huge salary increase. Although I had accepted the argument that the unusual pressures and demands in their occupation justified an increase, their demands would have cost taxpayers almost $700 million a year. I told Lewis to advise the union's leaders that, as a former union president, I was probably the best friend his organization ever had in the White House, but I could not countenance an illegal strike nor permit negotiations to take place as long as one was in progress. I hoped the air controllers realized I meant what I said.

PATCO was one of only a handful of national unions that had backed me in the election. By instinct and experience, I supported unions and the rights of workers to organize and